

STATUS: APPROVED

Purpose

This section defines the security principles that protect the CLA website, its visitors, and its content.

Security should be built into the website from the beginning rather than added later.

Security Philosophy

Security should support:

- * Visitor trust
- * Data protection
- * Website integrity
- * Long-term reliability

Every feature should be evaluated for potential security risks before implementation.

Data Collection

Only collect information that is genuinely necessary.

Examples include:

- * Contact forms
- * Prayer requests
- * Event registrations
- * Volunteer applications

Unnecessary personal data should never be collected.

Personal Information

Personal information should be handled responsibly.

Sensitive information should only be stored when required and should remain protected using appropriate security practices.

Form Security

Every public form should include appropriate protection against:

- * Spam
- * Automated submissions
- * Malicious input

Validation should occur on both the client and server whenever applicable.

File Uploads

Uploaded files should be:

- * Validated
- * Restricted to approved file types
- * Limited in size
- * Scanned when appropriate

Executable files should never be accepted.

Authentication

Administrative areas should use secure authentication.

Access should be limited according to user responsibilities.

Administrative accounts should follow strong password practices.

Dependencies

Third-party libraries and dependencies should remain:

- * Trusted
- * Maintained
- * Up to date

Unused dependencies should be removed whenever practical.

HTTPS

The entire website should always operate over HTTPS.

Secure connections are required for every public page and form.

Backups

Website data and content should be backed up regularly.

Recovery procedures should be documented and periodically verified.

Monitoring

The website should be monitored for:

- * Errors
- * Downtime
- * Security vulnerabilities
- * Performance issues

Problems should be investigated and resolved promptly.

Future Reviews

Security practices should be reviewed during every six-month architecture review.

New security recommendations may be adopted when they improve protection without creating unnecessary complexity.

Guiding Principle

Visitors should be able to trust the CLA website with confidence because security is treated as a fundamental responsibility.

End of Section 7